

MARKING SCHEME

COMPUTER SOFTWARE CAT 1

1. System Software vs Application Software

- *System Software:* Controls the hardware, manages system resources, and provides a platform for other applications to run (e.g., Operating Systems like Windows/Linux, Device Drivers, Utilities). *(2 marks for definition, 1 mark for two correct examples)*
- *Application Software:* End-user programs designed to help users perform specific business, educational, or personal tasks (e.g., MS Word, Accounting software, Web browsers). *(2 marks for definition, 1 mark for two correct examples)*

2. Methods to collect user needs (Any 4, 1 mark each):

- Questionnaires/Surveys distributed to staff.
- Direct interviews with department heads or users.
- Observation of current workflows and manual tasks.
- Reviewing existing system documentations, error logs, or reports.
- Brainstorming sessions/Focus group workshops.

3. Factors to consider in software selection (Any 4, 1 mark each):

- Cost (Initial licensing fee, maintenance costs vs allocated budget).
- Vendor support, reliability, and market reputation.
- Ease of use / User-friendliness (training requirements/learning curve).
- Security and data encryption features.
- Scalability (ability to grow with the business demands).
- Legality, licensing terms, and compliance requirements.

4. **Off-the-Shelf Software (1 mark per point, max 4):**

- *Advantages (Max 2):* Lower initial cost; immediately available for deployment; thoroughly tested by a large external user base; receives regular vendor updates.
- *Disadvantages (Max 2):* May contain unnecessary features that bloat the system; might lack specific niche features tailored to the business; potential high recurring renewal or subscription costs.

5. **Configuring local user accounts (Any 4, 1 mark each):**

- Setting/changing account passwords.
- Modifying Account Type (e.g., promoting Standard to Administrator).
- Changing the account name, profile picture, or directory paths.
- Setting parental controls, login hour restrictions, or time limits.
- Disabling, enabling, or deleting an inactive account.
- Enforcing password policies (e.g., forcing a password change at next login).

6. **Privilege Differences between Account Types (2 marks per type correctly explained):**

- *Administrator:* Holds full control over the OS; can install/uninstall all software and hardware components, modify system files, and change security settings.
- *Standard User:* Can run pre-installed applications and save files within their own home directory; cannot make system-wide modifications or install software that affects other profiles.
- *Guest:* Highly restricted, temporary access; cannot modify any system settings, install apps, or view other users' data. Files are usually deleted upon logout.

7. **Software Selection & Acquisition**

- **a) Step-by-step process (8 marks total - 2 marks per logical phase explained):**

1. *Needs Assessment*: Interview the accounting staff to map out workflow outputs, reporting needs, and compliance rules.
 2. *Market Research & Evaluation*: Shortlist existing accounting applications, compare vendor terms, and download trial versions for evaluation.
 3. *Feasibility & Compatibility Check*: Check if current office workstations meet the hardware and OS specifications. Calculate total cost of ownership (TCO).
 4. *Procurement & Documentation*: Finalize the contract, acquire legitimate licenses, and document the configuration details.
- o **b) Acquisition Methods (4 marks total):**
 - Candidate should list 2 methods (e.g., *Off-the-shelf* standard package vs *Bespoke* tailor-made system). (2 marks)
 - Preference scenario: Off-the-shelf is preferred if the firm needs immediate deployment on a low budget. Bespoke is preferred if the firm uses highly specialized, proprietary calculation workflows that standard software cannot compute. (2 marks)
8. **User Account Management & Security**
 - o **a) Account Recommendations & Justifications (6 marks total - 2 marks per entity):**
 - *Senior IT Admin: Administrator Account*. Required to perform system upgrades, manage patches, configure security protocols, and troubleshoot hardware. (2 marks)
 - *Permanent Receptionist: Standard User Account*. Allows daily operational activities (word processing, browsing portal, emails) while preventing accidental changes to core system files or malware installation. (2 marks)
 - *Visiting Clients/Interns: Guest Account*. Provides transient web or application access without cluttering storage, safeguarding permanent office data and configurations. (2 marks)

- **b) Security Risks (4 marks - 2 marks per valid risk explained):**
 - *Data Privacy Violations:* Unauthorized users could easily access, alter, or maliciously delete sensitive client data or financial records.
 - *Malware Exposure:* If a temporary user runs a malicious file on an unrestricted shared account, it can compromise or ransom the entire machine.
 - *Lack of Audit Trail/Accountability:* It becomes impossible to track who made unauthorized changes to files or system settings if everyone logs in with the exact same credential.